LayerSync
AI Systems & Digital Transformation

BUSINESS REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT · SYNC ESTATE

Sync Stay v1

Property management, from lease to landlord statement

Requirements for the build team to map Sync Stay v1: properties and leases, rent and receipts, arrears, deposits, maintenance, inspections, and portals for property managers, landlords and tenants. Kept deliberately simple, to replace spreadsheets, notebooks and receipt books first, then iterate.

Prepared by LayerSync · 16 October 2026 · Internal · Draft for team review

01 Purpose

Sync Stay v1 lets a property management team stop using spreadsheets, notebooks and manual receipt books to track who rents what, who has paid, and what is owed to each landlord.

The problem today

- Leases, tenants and units are tracked in Excel or on paper, so nobody has one reliable list.
- Rent is receipted in a manual receipt book, then retyped into Excel. Errors and missing receipts are common.
- Arrears are noticed late, usually when someone manually checks the book.
- Landlord statements are built by hand at month end, which takes days and causes disputes.
- Leases expire without anyone noticing, and maintenance requests get lost in WhatsApp.

> **v1 is successful when** a property manager can, without any spreadsheet: record a payment and issue a receipt in under a minute, see every tenant in arrears on one screen, and send every landlord their monthly statement in one click.

02 Scope

v1 covers residential and simple commercial lettings managed by an agency on behalf of landlords. Everything else waits for a later version.

In v1	Not in v1
Properties, units and landlords	Online rent payment (card, EcoCash, bank gateway)
Tenants and leases, with renewal and expiry alerts	Automatic bank-statement matching
Monthly rent charges generated automatically	SMS and WhatsApp notifications (email only in v1)
Recording payments and issuing receipts (USD and ZiG)	Commercial service-charge and escalation calculations
Arrears tracking and reminders	Utility metering and billing
Deposits held, applied and refunded	Offline inspections and e-signed inspection reports
Maintenance requests with status	Contractor/supplier portal
Inspections (move-in, routine, move-out) with photos and a PDF report	Tenant vetting and credit checks
Landlord statements (generated with Sync Finance)	Native mobile apps (v1 is a mobile-friendly web app)
Three portals: property manager, landlord, tenant	E-signatures on leases
Document storage per lease and property	

Money logic (trust account, commission, landlord payouts) lives in **Sync Finance**. Sync Stay creates the rent charges and records payments; Sync Finance does the accounting and statements. Sync Stay must still work for a firm that has only Sync Stay switched on (see section 8).

03 Users and portals

Three internal roles work in the main app; landlords and tenants each get their own simple portal and see only their own records.

User	Where they work	What they can do
Director / admin	Main app	Everything; sees all properties, all managers, all figures
Property manager	Main app	Manage their assigned properties, tenants, leases, payments and requests
Accounts clerk	Main app	Record payments, issue receipts, view arrears; cannot edit leases
Landlord	Landlord portal	View their properties, tenants, rent collected, arrears, maintenance requests, inspection reports, statements and documents; read-only
Tenant	Tenant portal	View their lease, balance, receipts and documents; submit and track maintenance requests

Rules

- A property manager sees only properties assigned to them, unless a director gives wider access.
- A landlord with several properties sees all of them under one login.
- A tenant never sees another tenant's or the landlord's financial information.
- Landlord and tenant logins are created by the agency (invite by email). There is no public sign-up.

04 Core workflow

The whole of v1 is this monthly cycle. If these nine steps work smoothly, the product does its job.

01 **Onboard a landlord and property.** Add the landlord, the property and its units, and the agreed management fee (percentage of rent).

02 **Let a unit.** Add the tenant, create the lease (start, end, monthly rent, currency, due day, deposit) and upload the signed lease. Do the move-in inspection with the tenant and attach the report.

03 **Record the deposit.** Receipt the deposit; it is held against the lease, not counted as rent.

04 **Rent is charged automatically.** On the 1st of each month (or the lease's due day), the system creates a rent charge for every active lease, and emails each tenant a rent invoice a few days beforehand.

05 **Record payment and issue a receipt.** The manager or clerk records cash, bank transfer or mobile money against the tenant. A numbered receipt is generated and emailed to the tenant, and is printable.

06 **Chase arrears.** Unpaid charges appear on the arrears list with days overdue. Reminder emails go out automatically at set intervals.

07 **Handle maintenance.** The tenant (or manager) logs a request; the manager assigns, updates and closes it. Any cost can be recorded as an expense against the property.

08 **Pay the landlord.** Sync Finance deducts commission and expenses and records the payout, either as each rent payment arrives or at month end (an agency setting), then produces each landlord's monthly statement.

09 **Renew or end the lease.** Expiry alerts go out 60 and 30 days before the end date. On move-out, the move-out inspection is compared with the move-in report, and the deposit is refunded or applied to amounts owed and damage, and the unit becomes vacant.

05 Functional requirements

"Must" items are required for v1 to launch. "Should" items go in v1 if time allows, otherwise v1.1.

5.1 Properties, units and landlords

ID	Requirement	Priority
ST-01	Create a landlord with name, phone, email, ID/company number and bank details for payouts	Must
ST-02	Create a property linked to one landlord, with address, type (residential, commercial) and assigned property manager	Must
ST-03	Add one or many units to a property; a house is a property with one unit	Must
ST-04	Set the management fee per property as a percentage of rent collected	Must
ST-05	Show each unit's status: occupied, vacant, notice given	Must
ST-06	Bulk import properties, units, landlords and tenants from an Excel template	Must

5.2 Tenants and leases

ID	Requirement	Priority
ST-10	Create a tenant (individual or company) with contact details and ID number	Must
ST-11	Create a lease linking tenant to unit, with start date, end date, monthly rent, currency (USD or ZiG), rent due day and deposit amount	Must
ST-12	Upload the signed lease and other documents to the lease record	Must
ST-13	Send lease-expiry alerts to the property manager 60 and 30 days before the end date	Must
ST-14	Renew a lease (new dates and rent) while keeping the history of the old one	Must
ST-15	End a lease, recording move-out date and reason, and set the unit to vacant	Must
ST-16	Record a planned annual rent increase on the lease, applied automatically on its date	Should

5.3 Rent charges, payments and receipts

ID	Requirement	Priority
ST-20	Automatically create a monthly rent charge for every active lease on its due day, and email the tenant a rent invoice a set number of days before (default 7)	Must
ST-21	Add one-off charges to a tenant (e.g. lease admin fee, damage, late fee, utilities recovery)	Must
ST-22	Record a payment against a tenant: date, amount, currency, method (cash, bank transfer, mobile money), reference	Must
ST-23	Allocate a payment to the oldest unpaid charge first; allow part payments and overpayments (credit carried forward)	Must
ST-24	Generate a sequentially numbered receipt for every payment, as a printable PDF, and email it to the tenant	Must
ST-25	Reverse a payment with a reason; never delete it (audit trail)	Must
ST-26	Show a running tenant statement: charges, payments and balance	Must

5.4 Arrears

ID	Requirement	Priority
ST-30	Arrears list of every tenant owing money, with amount and days overdue (0–30, 31–60, 61–90, 90+)	Must
ST-31	Filter arrears by property manager, property and landlord	Must
ST-32	Automatic reminder emails to tenants at set intervals after the due date (e.g. 3, 7 and 14 days)	Must
ST-33	Log notes against a tenant's arrears (calls made, promises to pay)	Should

5.5 Deposits

ID	Requirement	Priority
ST-40	Record a deposit received, held against the lease and kept separate from rent, noting where it is held (trust, business account or paid to the landlord)	Must
ST-41	At move-out, apply the deposit to amounts owed, refund the balance, or both, with a record of each	Must
ST-42	Report of all deposits currently held, by property and landlord	Must

5.6 Maintenance requests

ID	Requirement	Priority
ST-50	Tenant or manager logs a request with description, unit and optional photos	**Must**
ST-51	Request status: new, in progress, done; assigned to a staff member	**Must**
ST-52	Tenant is emailed when status changes	**Must**
ST-53	Record the cost of a repair as an expense against the property, flowing to the landlord statement	**Must**
ST-54	Landlord sees every maintenance request on their properties in the landlord portal, read-only: description, photos, status, assigned staff, dates and cost	**Must**
ST-55	Landlord is emailed when a request on their property is logged and when it is completed, with the cost	Should
ST-56	Repairs above an amount set per landlord need the landlord's approval in the portal before work starts	Should

5.7 Inspections

Three kinds, done on a phone at the property: **move-in** (records the condition the tenant receives), **routine** (every few months, to spot problems early and reassure the landlord) and **move-out** (compared with move-in to decide deposit deductions). Every report is stored under its property, unit and lease.

ID	Requirement	Priority
ST-70	Create an inspection for a unit: type (move-in, routine, move-out), date and inspector	**Must**
ST-71	Room-by-room checklist from a standard list, editable per unit (e.g. lounge, kitchen, bedroom 1, bathroom, exterior): condition (good, fair, poor, damaged) and a note per room	**Must**
ST-72	Take or upload photos against each room from a phone, compressed for weak connections	**Must**
ST-73	Overall comments, and meter readings (water, electricity) at move-in and move-out	Should
ST-74	Save as draft and finish later; once completed, the report is locked and only added to with a dated note	**Must**
ST-75	Generate a branded PDF inspection report with photos, stored under the property, unit and lease	**Must**
ST-76	Email the report to the landlord and show it in the landlord portal; the tenant gets the move-in and move-out reports	**Must**
ST-77	Raise a maintenance request from any room in an inspection in one click	**Must**
ST-78	Set a routine inspection interval per unit (e.g. every 3 or 6 months), with a reminder to the property manager when one is due	**Must**
ST-79	Show the move-out report beside the move-in report, room by room, to support deposit deductions	Should
ST-80	Tenant acknowledges the move-in report in the tenant portal, or adds comments within a set period (e.g. 7 days)	Should

5.8 Notifications

ID	Requirement	Priority
ST-60	Email notifications for: receipt issued, rent reminder, lease expiry, maintenance status, inspection due, inspection report ready, statement ready	Must
ST-61	All alerts also appear in the Hub notification centre for staff	Must
ST-62	Notification templates editable by the agency admin (wording and logo)	Should

06 Screens and reports

Each portal opens on one dashboard that answers its user's main question. Everything else is one click away.

Property manager (main app)

- **Dashboard:** rent due this month, collected so far, total arrears, vacant units, leases expiring in 60 days, open maintenance requests, inspections due.
- **Screens:** properties, units, landlords, tenants, leases, payments, arrears, deposits, maintenance, inspections, documents.
- **Quick action:** "Record payment" available from every screen, since it is the most frequent task.
- **Reports (export to PDF and Excel):** rent roll, arrears by age, vacancy list, lease expiry list, deposits held, payments received by date range, inspections due and overdue.

Landlord portal

- **Dashboard:** rent collected this month, arrears on their properties, occupancy, open maintenance requests.
- **Screens:** their properties and units, current tenants (name and lease dates only), maintenance requests (status, photos, cost), monthly statements, inspection reports, documents.
- **Reports:** monthly statement (download PDF), statement history.

Tenant portal

- **Dashboard:** current balance and next due date.
- **Screens:** lease details and documents, receipts and statement, move-in and move-out inspection reports, maintenance requests (log new, track existing).
- **Note:** must work well on a basic smartphone, as most tenants will only use a phone.

07 Data

These are the business records v1 needs; Andre and Tino will design the actual schema. Records marked Hub are shared across modules and owned by the Hub.

Record	Key fields	Owner
Contact (landlord, tenant)	Name, type (individual/company), phone, email, ID/company no., bank details (landlords)	Hub
Property	Name/address, type, landlord, assigned manager, management fee %	Hub
Unit	Property, unit number/name, bedrooms, status, room list, routine inspection interval	Sync Stay

Record	Key fields	Owner
Lease	Tenant, unit, start, end, rent, currency, due day, deposit, status, documents	Sync Stay
Charge	Lease/tenant, type (rent, one-off), amount, currency, due date, status (unpaid, part-paid, paid)	Sync Stay
Payment	Tenant, date, amount, currency, method, reference, allocations, receipt number, reversed flag	Sync Stay (read by Sync Finance)
Deposit	Lease, amount received, amount applied, amount refunded, balance	Sync Stay
Maintenance request	Unit, raised by, description, photos, status, assignee, cost, linked inspection	Sync Stay
Inspection	Unit, lease, type (move-in, routine, move-out), date, inspector, rooms (condition, note, photos), meter readings, comments, status (draft, completed), report PDF, tenant acknowledgement	Sync Stay
Expense	Property, date, description, amount, supplier, recharge to landlord (yes/no)	Sync Finance
Document	Linked record, file, type, uploaded by, date	Hub

Currency rule: every amount carries its currency. A lease is in one currency, and its charges, payments and balances stay in that currency. No automatic conversion between USD and ZiG in v1.

08 Integrations

Sync Stay sits on the Hub, sends its money data to Sync Finance, and receives new tenants from SynCRM.

Connects to	Direction	What flows
Sync Estate Hub	Both	Login, roles, users, shared contacts and properties, documents, notifications, dashboard figures (collected, arrears, occupancy)
Sync Finance	Stay → Finance	Every payment, deposit, charge and repair cost, so Finance can post to the trust account, take the management fee and produce landlord statements
Sync Finance	Finance → Stay	Landlord statements and payout status, shown in the landlord portal
SynCRM	CRM → Stay	When a rental deal is marked "let" in SynCRM, the tenant and unit are offered to create a lease in one click, with no retyping

> **If Sync Finance is not switched on:** Sync Stay still records payments, issues receipts and shows arrears. It produces a simple landlord statement itself (rent collected, less management fee, less recorded expenses). The full trust ledger and payouts need Sync Finance.

09 Non-functional requirements and acceptance

Non-functional

- **Multi-tenant:** one platform, many agencies; each agency's data fully separated.

- **Mobile-friendly:** every screen usable on a smartphone, especially the tenant portal and "Record payment".
- **Low bandwidth:** pages load acceptably on a weak mobile connection; no heavy images by default.
- **Audit trail:** every payment, reversal, lease change and deposit movement logs who did it and when. Financial records are never hard-deleted.
- **Security:** role-based access enforced on the server, not just hidden in the interface. Landlord and tenant portals show only their own records.
- **Backups:** daily, with the ability to restore an agency's data.
- **Receipts and statements:** carry the agency's name and logo, print cleanly on A4.

v1 is accepted when an agency can do all of this without a spreadsheet

- [ ] Import its existing properties, landlords, tenants and leases from Excel
- [ ] See rent charges created automatically on the due date
- [ ] Record a payment and email a receipt in under a minute
- [ ] See a correct arrears list, aged by days overdue
- [ ] Hold and refund a deposit correctly at move-out
- [ ] Log and close a maintenance request, with the tenant notified
- [ ] Produce a correct monthly landlord statement
- [ ] Give a landlord and a tenant a login that shows only their own information
- [ ] Complete a move-in inspection on a phone, with photos, and send the PDF report to the landlord

10 Open questions for Andre and Tino

- [ ] How much of Tino's existing property management system can be reused, and is it cleared for commercial reuse?
- [ ] Build Sync Stay on the existing SynCRM codebase and database, or as a separate service sharing the Hub?
- [ ] Email provider for receipts and reminders, and expected monthly volume per agency
- [ ] ZiG handling: do we need ZiG at launch, or USD only with ZiG in v1.1?
- [ ] Receipt numbering: one sequence per agency, or per branch?
- [ ] Do we support a tenant renting more than one unit under one account in v1?
- [ ] Realistic build estimate for the Must items, and which Should items fit
- [ ] Photo storage for inspections: where photos are kept, compression level, and whether we cap storage per agency
- [ ] Is an offline mode needed in v1 for inspections at properties with no signal, or is save-as-draft enough?

> **Pricing basis for Sync Stay.** Current pricing counts only agency staff using the module. Sync Stay also has landlord and tenant portal logins, and its load grows with the number of properties and units (records, inspection photos, emails). What does each unit and each portal user actually cost us to host and support? That answer decides whether Sync Stay is priced by staff users, by units under management, or both. Proposed starting point for the partners: landlord and tenant logins free and unlimited, price by bands of units managed.